AI Adoption Interview Notes

Anonymized Appendix Summaries

CMET 6000 - Final Report Interview Notes

Confidentiality note: These appendices use anonymous attribution. Personal names, employer names, exact company identifiers, locations, employee counts, and other identifying company details have been removed. The summaries paraphrase the interview content and do not include direct quotations.

Interview Notes Overview

The following appendices summarize four interviews or written interview responses collected for a final report on artificial intelligence adoption in construction, facilities, and related owner-side operations. The summaries are organized by participant role and industry context rather than by personal or company name.

The interviews focused on how organizations are using AI tools, how those tools were selected and implemented, what benefits and barriers have been observed, and what participants expect AI to change over the next several years.

Anonymous Participant List

Appendix	Anonymous Participant Label	Primary Focus
Appendix A	Participant A - Project Manager, General Contractor	Project management, document control, meeting minutes, and field coordination support
Appendix B	Participant B - Construction Technology Manager, General Contractor	Construction technology, VDC, reality capture, AI pilots, and safety/progress tracking
Appendix C	Participant C - IT Director, Healthcare/Owner Organization	AI governance, healthcare data security, clinical documentation, and internal agents
Appendix D	Participant D - Construction Executive, General Contractor	Executive strategy, data security, AI agents, and process improvement

Cross-Interview Theme Snapshot

Theme	Evidence Across Interviews	Implication for Final Report
Governance and data protection	Participants repeatedly emphasized security, privacy, permissions, and leadership review before scaling AI tools.	AI adoption is not only a technical decision; it also requires policy, trust, and risk management.
Low-risk pilot projects first	Several participants described committees, pilot teams, limited rollouts, or crawl-walk-run strategies.	Gradual implementation helps organizations test value before broad deployment.
Document-heavy work as an early win	Meeting minutes, email summaries, specifications, submittals, subcontract reviews, internal procedures, and EMR messages were common AI use cases.	AI currently appears most useful where work is text-heavy, repetitive, or search-intensive.
Human review remains necessary	Participants described AI as a supplemental tool rather than a replacement for professional judgment.	AI can improve efficiency, but final accountability still rests with trained personnel.
Field adoption is slower	Interviewees noted that field work has messier data, higher consequences for error, and more resistance to new workflows.	Construction field applications may require better data capture, practical training, and strong trust-building.

Appendix A: Participant A - Project Manager, General Contractor

Interview Context

Participant A works in a project management role for a general contractor. The role includes office-side project support such as submittals, pay applications, RFIs, drawing and document control, subcontractor coordination, material release tracking, scheduling support, and coordination with field leadership.

Current AI Use and Tools

- The participant described AI as a supplement to normal project management workflows rather than a stand-alone replacement for staff judgment.
- Meeting-related AI tools are used to support notes from owner-architect-contractor meetings and subcontractor meetings. The AI-generated summaries help capture commitments, schedule items, open questions, and action items, but the project team still reviews and edits the final minutes.
- A construction management platform with AI search is used to locate information in specifications, submittals, and drawings. This is especially helpful when a project team needs a quick answer in the field instead of manually searching a long specification book or drawing set.
- The participant also discussed early safety-related uses of reality capture, including 360-degree jobsite imagery that can flag potential safety issues such as missing PPE.

Adoption and Implementation

- The project management platform was introduced through a structured rollout rather than being forced onto all users at once.
- Leadership and department heads were involved because the platform required both financial investment and broad workflow change.
- Training was provided through recurring office-hour style sessions focused on specific tools and workflows such as meeting minutes, schedules, and document management.
- The rollout worked best when internal users had designated contacts who could answer questions and help others learn the system.

Benefits Observed

- AI-supported meeting notes allow the project manager to focus more on the conversation instead of trying to type every detail in real time.
- AI search reduces the time required to find specification sections, product requirements, and drawing details.
- The participant believed AI can make meetings more efficient and documentation more complete, especially when used as a backup to human notes.
- Safety and image-based AI tools may help safety personnel identify risks across multiple jobsites more efficiently.

Challenges and Barriers

- The participant emphasized that AI-generated output still requires human checking because the tool may misidentify speakers, miss context, or assign comments incorrectly.
- Field adoption can be slower because field teams are often working from tablets and may be more comfortable with previous processes.
- Cost and training are major factors when adopting large construction technology platforms.
- Some meeting participants may be hesitant about AI transcription, so permission and transparency matter.

Future Outlook and Advice

- The participant expects AI to continue supporting safety monitoring, document search, and project administration.
- For firms beginning AI adoption, the participant recommended starting with a smaller group of trained internal champions before rolling tools out more widely.
- The participant also suggested including representatives from different departments so adoption is not viewed as being pushed by only one group.

Key Takeaway

- For project management teams, AI is currently most useful as an efficiency and documentation support tool. It helps capture, search, and organize information, but the project team still needs to verify the results and make final decisions.

Appendix B: Participant B - Construction Technology Manager, General Contractor

Interview Context

Participant B leads construction technology for a general contractor. The role includes technology beyond standard IT support, including drones, 360-degree photos, laser scans, VDC/BIM coordination, photorealistic renderings, and technology support that varies by project type and budget.

Current AI Use and Tools

- The participant described AI as a tool that should solve specific business problems rather than being adopted simply because it is new or popular.
- The organization formed an AI focus group to identify pain points and an implementation group to evaluate whether solutions should be built internally or purchased from vendors.
- Microsoft Copilot is being piloted because it integrates with existing productivity software and provides a more controlled environment for company data.
- Meeting intelligence tools can summarize long meetings, identify action items, and create transcripts or meeting notes.
- Reality capture tools, including 360-degree photos and drone imagery, are being combined with AI to identify jobsite conditions, safety issues, and potential progress tracking opportunities.

Adoption and Implementation

- The participant emphasized a walk-before-run approach. The organization is not trying to buy every new technology at once; instead, it is testing tools that fit defined needs.
- Pilot projects were selected because the teams involved were more technology-forward and willing to experiment with new workflows.
- The organization plans to check back with pilot teams over time to determine whether the expected benefits actually occurred and whether teams discovered additional use cases.
- The participant described the best AI as technology that works in the background and improves existing workflows without forcing workers to completely change their day-to-day behavior.

Benefits Observed

- Email and meeting summarization can reduce the burden of reading long threads or manually documenting every discussion.
- AI-assisted safety reporting from 360-degree imagery can help identify missing PPE or other risk conditions and compile reports for review.
- AI-driven progress tracking could compare reality-capture data to BIM models and help estimate completion percentages for trades such as ductwork or insulation.

- Progress tracking could also help superintendents challenge schedule excuses and better coordinate which trades should be working in which areas.

Challenges and Barriers

- The participant noted that construction is historically slower to adopt new technology, even though workers eventually accept tools that clearly make their work easier.
- Trust is a major barrier. Experienced field professionals may worry that technology is being used to replace their judgment rather than support it.
- Training, time constraints, and budget limitations all affect whether AI tools can be adopted successfully.
- AI output must be paired with construction knowledge because a digital model or AI result is only useful if it reflects how work can actually be built in the field.

Future Outlook and Advice

- The participant expects AI progress tracking, reality capture, and model comparison to become increasingly useful for construction logistics and trade coordination.
- AI may help superintendents see where work is actually complete and where crews can be redirected, reducing wasted time and improving schedule control.
- For young professionals interested in VDC or construction technology, the participant recommended gaining field experience so that digital coordination decisions are grounded in constructability.
- The participant stressed humility and curiosity: technology professionals should ask field workers questions and learn from trade expertise.

Key Takeaway

- For construction technology teams, AI adoption should begin with real operational problems, not with the technology itself. The strongest opportunities involve background automation, reality capture, safety review, and progress tracking, but success depends on trust, training, and field knowledge.

Appendix C: Participant C - IT Director, Healthcare/Owner Organization

Interview Context

Participant C serves in an IT leadership role for a healthcare/owner organization, with responsibility for applications integration. The interview focused on AI governance, patient data protection, clinical documentation, EMR-related AI functions, and internally developed AI agents.

Current AI Use and Tools

- The organization created an AI governance committee with senior leadership and representatives from multiple areas before broadly implementing AI tools.
- AI is being used within the primary electronic medical record environment to help draft responses to patient messages. The provider must review, accept, edit, or reject the AI-generated response before it is sent.
- Ambient clinical documentation tools are used during patient visits to listen to provider-patient conversations and draft medical notes based on the discussion.
- The IT team has created custom internal AI agents that answer specific questions and perform limited tasks through controlled API connections.
- Examples of internal agent tasks include validating and rebooting a user computer and identifying who is on call for a specific team.

Adoption and Implementation

- All proposed AI tools or use cases must go through the AI governance committee for review.
- Requests can come from end users, leadership, or vendor-provided AI features that become available in existing systems.
- The organization uses a crawl-walk-run model: governance review, pilot testing, KPI measurement, and then broader scaling if the tool proves useful.
- Custom agents are built in a controlled enterprise environment because healthcare data requires strict privacy and security safeguards.

Benefits Observed

- AI-assisted provider message drafting can improve speed and efficiency while keeping clinical review in the loop.
- Ambient documentation reduces the time providers spend writing notes after patient visits.
- An internal computer-reboot agent reduces help desk tickets by allowing validated users to initiate a common support action themselves.
- An internal on-call lookup agent saves time by combining schedule lookup and contact information into a single request.
- The participant estimated that each of two internal agent functions saves roughly nine hours per week by reducing repetitive support and lookup work.

Challenges and Barriers

- The largest barrier is protecting patient information and ensuring AI tools remain compliant with healthcare privacy requirements.
- The organization must verify that data entered into AI tools is not stored or exposed on public or unsecured servers.
- There is understandable caution around connecting AI tools to systems that may contain protected information.
- The participant emphasized that leadership alignment is necessary so teams do not build AI tools that fail to match strategic priorities.

Future Outlook and Advice

- The participant expects AI to continue expanding through governed pilots, KPI tracking, and controlled scaling.
- For other organizations beginning AI adoption, the participant recommended starting with governance, getting leadership involved, and identifying pilot users who can provide honest feedback.
- The participant also recommended measuring value with KPIs so that AI implementation is connected to efficiency, quality, and strategic goals rather than experimentation alone.

Key Takeaway

- For healthcare and owner-side organizations, AI adoption must be built around governance, data security, and measurable value. The interview showed that AI agents can save time on repetitive support tasks, but sensitive data requires careful controls before tools are scaled.

Appendix D: Participant D - Construction Executive, General Contractor

Interview Context

Participant D provided an executive-level written response from the general contracting perspective. The participant is involved in technology strategy, process improvement, and AI adoption for construction operations.

Current AI Use and Tools

- The participant stated that many employees use AI for research, quick answers, and productivity support.
- The organization uses Microsoft Copilot broadly and has approved limited use of code-assistance tools for software development and process improvement work.
- The organization is exploring AI agents for subcontract review and for answering questions about internal standards and processes.
- The participant sees agents as a major future use case because construction includes many document-heavy workflows.

Adoption and Implementation

- Tool selection has focused heavily on security, data handling, and whether company information could be used to train external models.
- Leadership is actively supporting the AI initiative rather than leaving adoption only to individual employees.
- Training has focused on helping employees use Copilot properly, while a smaller advanced group is learning more about agent development and specialized use cases.
- The participant described the rollout as slow and steady, beginning with lower-risk uses and building trust from demonstrated value.

Benefits Observed

- The participant identified time savings in contract-related and subcontract-review tasks as one of the clearest early benefits.
- Internal process agents may reduce the time employees spend searching for answers about how the company performs standard tasks.
- AI is viewed as especially useful for research, document review, process support, and reducing repetitive administrative work.

Challenges and Barriers

- The biggest challenge is protecting proprietary company data and maintaining control over how information is stored or reused.
- The participant noted that construction is a traditional industry, so people need time to trust AI output.

- Vendor security reviews are important because a tool can be useful but still inappropriate if it creates data risk.
- Field operations have not benefited as much yet because field work is physical, data can be inconsistent, and errors may have greater consequences.

Future Outlook and Advice

- The participant expects AI agents to handle more document-heavy and process-heavy work in construction over the next several years.
- Companies that solve the data security and governance problem early may gain an advantage because they can scale AI tools more confidently.
- For firms beginning AI adoption, the participant recommended getting the security and data strategy right first, then choosing a few real business problems where AI can create visible wins.

Key Takeaway

- From the executive perspective, AI adoption in construction depends on balancing innovation with risk management. The strongest near-term opportunities are document review, internal knowledge retrieval, and process automation, but success depends on data security and trust.